

Relevance Codebook

Code: Relevant (1)

Definition:

An article is marked *Relevant* (1) if it contains explicit content directly discussing Mpox in relation to the human epidemic context.

Criteria (one or more must apply explicitly):

- Mpox case counts, geographic spread, infection rates.
- Mpox transmission patterns, e.g., discussion of how it spreads between people.
- Information about Mpox vaccines, availability, development, distribution.
- Identification or discussion of at-risk groups (e.g., MSM, immunocompromised individuals, anyone who engages in close contact with a patient).
- Descriptions/critiques of the public health response (e.g., health advisories, CDC/WHO statements, local health campaigns).
- Details about epidemiological characteristics of Mpox (e.g., symptoms, strains, zoonotic origins when tied to the outbreak).
- Discussion of media coverage or representation of Mpox in the news or public discourse.
- Government policy, funding, or international efforts directly targeting Mpox.
- Personal stories about people dealing with Mpox/stigma due to Mpox.

Code: Irrelevant (0)

Definition:

An article is marked *Irrelevant* if it does not substantively discuss Mpox in a way related to the epidemic, or mentions it only in passing, satirical, or non-human contexts.

Criteria (one or more must apply/none of the relevance criteria applies):

- Incomplete Scrapes
 - Article is cut off mid-sentence or has only a headline or metadata. (Keep articles where they're cut off from a paragraph or so, leaving the scraped data still coherent, no need to cross check with links)
- Non-English articles
- Briefings/Quick Hits/Highlight Memos
 - Summarized, non-substantive listings with no in-depth coverage.
 - E.g., “Top 5 health stories today: flu, Mpox, RSV...”

- General Discussion of Public Health/Diseases/Vaccines
 - Mpox only mentioned as one of many diseases in a broad context.
 - E.g., “Vaccination efforts continue for diseases such as flu, Mpox, and measles.”
- Satirical or Throwaway Mentions
 - Mpox used as a joke, stereotype, or stigmatizing punchline.
 - E.g., “Avoid gay men or you’ll get Mpox — just kidding, but be careful!”
- Animal/Primate/Zoonotic Research (without human epidemic connection)
 - Mpox mentioned in the context of animal studies or general zoonoses.
 - E.g., “Study finds new poxvirus in African rodents; Mpox cited as historical example.”
- Hyperlinked References Only
 - Mpox is only mentioned in a hyperlink or suggested reading, not in the body.
 - E.g., “... a variety of poxviruses [read more here].”
- General LGBTQ+ Issue Coverage
 - Mpox name-dropped in a list of issues affecting the queer community but not discussed.
 - E.g., “From mental health to Mpox, queer health is under threat.”

Note

- Ambiguous Mentions: If it’s unclear whether the article is relevant, lean toward exclusion and mark it *irrelevant*.
- Mixed Content: If an article contains some irrelevant framing (e.g., satire, general disease mentions) but also includes relevant details (case counts, public health response, etc.), mark as *Relevant*.
- Contextual Zoonosis: If zoonotic origins or animal vectors are discussed with direct connection to the current human outbreak, mark *Relevant*.
- Focus on explicit content — assume implicit relevance (e.g., inferred risk or allusion) is not sufficient.

Coding question

Read the article carefully and answer the following question:

Is the article relevant to the Mpox epidemic of 2022?

- A. Irrelevant (0)
- B. Relevant (1)